

A nested loop has been created using *while*, where we command the statements within the inner brackets to execute, until the value of the variable *a* is equal to 12. A simple multiplication operator is used next to actually compute the product, while the display statement, (via the *echo* command), ensures that you see the tables displayed in your browser window. Finally, after every loop we have incremented the value of *\$a*.

If you notice, we have added the statement “*\$a=1*” inside the *for* statement, else once the value of *\$a* becomes 12, the program will terminate after just displaying one set of the two-times table.

Let’s see some more practical examples of PHP code. Below is a program that changes the background colour of the browser page based on which day it is. A simple array (we have covered arrays later in this chapter), *\$bgcolor*, has been defined, with the respective colours for the seven days of the week. Note that the colours defined are in hexadecimal format. Hexadecimal format is a very compact and easily convertible to and from other systems, like the decimal and binary system. A base of 16 is used, including numbers from zero to nine (0–9), and the first six letters of the English language, i.e. A, B, C, D, E and F. Another variable “*\$today*” which is assigned the “*date*” function, and a variable *x*. The date function as you might have guessed is responsible for getting the current system date.

The simple output of this program will be the statement “This just changes the colour of the screen based on the day of the week”, with the background colour of the screen of course changing according to the day of the week.